

From **How to Build a Course** — the full guide has the rest.

Appendix A — Bloom’s Taxonomy (full reference)

Six levels, low to high. Each level’s definition and a full list of measurable action verbs. Pick the verb that matches what you want students to actually do. (*Anderson & Krathwohl, 2001 — revised Bloom’s.*)

Note: some verbs appear at more than one level (e.g., *choose, compare, select*). That’s expected — a verb’s level is set by the **cognitive task**, not the word alone. “Compare two options” can be Understand, Analyze, or Evaluate depending on what the comparison demands. Use the level that matches the thinking you want.

Level	What it asks of the student	Measurable action verbs
1. Remember	recall facts, terms, and basic concepts	choose, define, find, identify, label, list, locate, match, name, omit, recall, recognize, relate, select, show, spell, state, tell, what, when, where, which, who, why
2. Understand	explain ideas; organize, compare, interpret	classify, compare, contrast, demonstrate, explain, extend, illustrate, infer, interpret, outline, paraphrase, rephrase, show, summarize, translate
3. Apply	use knowledge in new situations; solve problems	apply, build, choose, construct, develop, experiment with, identify, interview, make use of, model, organize, plan, select, solve, utilize

Level	What it asks of the student	Measurable action verbs
4. Analyze	break into parts; find evidence, motives, relationships	analyze, assume, categorize, classify, compare, conclude, contrast, discover, dissect, distinguish, divide, examine, function, inspect, list, motive, simplify, survey, test for, theme
5. Evaluate	judge against criteria; defend an opinion or decision	appraise, argue, assess, award, choose, conclude, criticize, decide, deduct, defend, determine, disprove, estimate, evaluate, importance, influence, interpret, judge, justify, mark, measure, prioritize, prove, rate, recommend, rule on, select, support, value
6. Create	combine elements into a new pattern; propose alternatives	adapt, build, change, combine, compile, compose, construct, create, delete, design, develop, discuss, elaborate, estimate, formulate, imagine, improve, invent, make up, maximize, minimize, modify, originate, plan, predict, propose, solve, suppose, test

Words to avoid (not measurable)

You can't observe these — replace each with a verb above: *believe, comprehend, conceptualize, experience, feel, grasp, hear, know, learn, listen, memorize, perceive, realize, see, understand* — and phrases like *appreciation for..., awareness of..., familiar with..., knowledge of..., understanding of...*

Not a contradiction: the *level Understand* (above) is legitimate — it's the vague *verb* "understand" that isn't measurable. Reach for the Understand-level

verbs (explain, interpret, summarize) instead.
